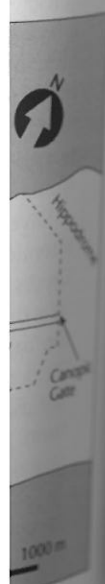


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Babylonian names. He may well have had a local wife and been respected by the local people.) Mazaeus was the first Persian appointed to a satrap's position under Alexander.

A tax official was appointed, as was a commander of the Macedonian garrison, Apollodorus, a Greek. This arrangement—a Persian or local satrap combined with a Macedonian or Greek military commander and a financial official—was to become a common feature of Alexander's administrative organisation.

India

India, like Egypt, was a special case. The Persians had not really controlled the area for some time and so Alexander was forced to adapt local systems of government. Native princes, if friendly, were left in control of their lands with the lands of hostile neighbours added to their own. Satraps were appointed, and the princes were subordinate to him. Alexander saw the Hydaspes River as the eastern extent of his empire and so instigated a new form of administrative control over the region past it. Porus was made king of all the land conquered in India and became both satrap and king. No Macedonian troops were left there and the area became a 'buffer' zone that was subject to Alexander, yet friendly.

Hellenizing the empire? Building new cities

One means of controlling and administering the empire was by building cities that were Macedonian and Greek colonies. Alexander reportedly built seventy of these. Only a few have been accurately identified today, including Alexandria in Egypt, Alexandria Areion (Herat) and Alexandria of the Caucasus (Kabul). Each city had a gymnasium, agora, Greek-style temples and usually an acropolis. Five to ten thousand Greeks and Macedonians, usually veteran troops who had retired from active service in the army, were settled in each city. Large numbers of locals were forced to farm the land around the city to help these colonists.

The site of each city was selected mainly for strategic military, administrative or trade reasons. Most of the cities were established in the east in Bactria, Aria, Arachosia and Sogdiana, areas that lacked existing cities. New cities encouraged trade, communication and control, and provided places to leave behind sick and injured troops and supply routes for the army. These cities were subject to the satraps and were important in holding the empire together.

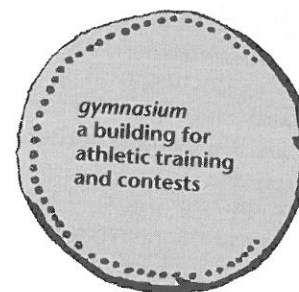
Alexandria in Egypt

The site of Alexandria was most conveniently set near to the harbour of Pharos, and by judicious town-planning [Alexander] made the city breathe with the etesian winds [north-west summer breezes]. As these blow across the open sea they cool the city's atmosphere and furnish the inhabitants with a moderate and healthy climate. The circuit wall that he set up was of vast size and marvelously strong. Situated between a great lake and the sea it has only two approaches from the landward side, and they are narrow and eminently defensible. In shape rather like a cloak, it has an avenue that almost cuts the city in half, and is remarkable for its size and beauty. It runs a distance of forty stades [about 7.5 kilometres] from gate to gate, and is a plethron [about 30 metres] wide, the whole decorated with varied facades of houses and sacred buildings. Alexander ordered a palace to be built, outstanding for its size and massiveness, and not only he, but successive rulers of Egypt up to my time have almost all improved the palace with elaborate additions.

DIODORUS SICULUS, 17.52.2-4

Coinage

Alexander introduced a uniform silver currency based on the Attic standard. Everyone in the empire was encouraged to use this. The uniform currency was designed to foster trade throughout the empire. Older currencies were still used and areas such as Babylon and Phoenicia were allowed to maintain their own trading links and coins.



Study the source

- What was special about Alexandria according to Diodorus?
- What do you think was the main reason for the building of this city?

